out of this process. But this was not the reality. Every strata made their own plans—lacking the empathy factor.

(ii) Only Central Plans were implemented as the states lacked the required level of the finance to support their plans. They ultimately had to be satisfied by implementing the Central Plans which failed to include the states' empathy.

(iii) As the Local Bodies in India were not having any constitutional mandate, they just played the complementary roles to the state Planning process. As they had no financial independence, their plans, even if they were formulated, remained on paper only.

(iv) The MLP, thus, failed to include the people's participation in planning, badly betraying the local aspirations.[91]

But at least the failure of the MLP made the Government to think in the direction of decentralised planning afresh leading to the enactment of the two important Constitutional Amendments–the 73rd and the 74th.

WAY TO DECENTRALISED PLANNING

Economic planning was basically an element of the centralised kind of political system (i.e. the socialist and the communist). When India decided in favour of planned economy it was to face double challenge:

(i) First challenge was to realise the objectives of planning in a time-bound frame and

(ii) Making economic planning a suitable instrument of development in the democratic set up was the other challenge—to democratise and decentralise the process of planning itself.

The Government tried to decentralise the planning process by setting up the NDC and promoting the MLP but without being able to achieve the desired results. By the late 1980s, a direct link was established[92] between development and democracy. And it was established that the above-given challenges were basically complementary—without solving the second challenge (i.e. decentralisation) the first challenge (i.e. development) cannot be solved. Finally, once the PRIs were given the constitutional status first